RSS Digest
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1. Qwen 3.8 27B on my laptop can interpret model weights, too
Source: Simon Willison’s Weblog | Published: 2026-11-03T16:29:48+00:00
Link: https://simonwillison.net/2026/Nov/3/qwen-can-interpret-model-weights/
Yesterday’s hot paper was Sparks of Weight-Space Programming: LLMs can natively read & write neural network weights by Rikiya Takehi, Jayden Teoh, Alex Zhang, and Omar Khattab. The paper (OK, the authors classify is as a "blog post", but it’s paper-shaped) found that frontier models, in particular GPT-6 Astra, can both interpret and modify the raw weights of a machine learning model - literally a text description of the model containing a bunch of floating point numbers. I’ve been playing with one of the examples from the paper and I’m delighted to share that Qwen 3.8 27B running on my laptop can do this as well! Weight-Space Programming Here’s the highlight from their abstract, describing impressive capabilities for GPT-6 Astra and coining the term Weight-Space Programming for when LLMs analyze and modify model weights: Just by looking at the raw weights, GPT-6 Astra can tell what a network was trained to do . And without any environment feedback, it has no trouble writing, from scratch, small game-playing networks that outplay networks trained with PPO for 100 million steps. Likewise, asked to make Qwen3.5-0.8B better at math without gradients, Astra identifies an issue in its w...

2. The U.S. Census Bureau and ?Super Intelligence?
Source: Simon Willison’s Weblog | Published: 2026-11-02T13:31:26+00:00
Link: https://simonwillison.net/2026/Nov/2/census-bureau-super-intelligence/
I was reminded today of AI Adoption Rate Trending Down for Large Companies , a chart produced by Apollo Global Management in September 2025, which appeared to show a slowdown in U.S. corporate AI adoption based on numbers collected by the U.S. Census Bureau. At the time I used that chart to demonstrate GPT-5 data analysis , and then to experiment with Claude’s new Code Interpreter . I decided to try running those numbers again to see what had changed over the past year, and in doing so learned that the Bureau has fallen foul of Executive Order 14434 , aka the asinine Super Intelligence one. First, the updated chart Every two weeks the U.S. Census Bureau runs a survey called the Business Trends and Outlook Survey (aka BTOS). Each time it goes to 200,000 businesses out of 1.2 million total - the surveyed group (a "panel") cycles such that an individual business only completes the survey every twelve weeks. The latest data is published on alternating Thursdays at 10am. I used the most recent numbers (published October 22, 2026) to create a new version (GPT-6 Astra Extra High transcript) of the AI adoption chart, updated to reflect both the last twelve months and a change that was m...

3. Apple Begins Opening Siri AI to Developers
Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-11-03T23:58:49Z
Link: https://developer.apple.com/news/?id=gdk2umrf
Apple Developer: Starting today with the iOS 27.3, iPadOS 27.3, macOS 27.3, and visionOS 27.3 betas, a new Developer Preview enables any developer to integrate their app with Siri AI, giving businesses and developers new ways to reach and serve their customers. [...] This developer beta offers a sneak peek at Siri AI app intents for developers. With this early Developer Preview, your app can work directly with Siri AI, giving you a first look at new ways to reach and serve your customers. This preview provides early access before first shipping to customers in a few months; and with submission to the App Store opening up in the spring, developers have time to explore, build, and help shape their experiences before launch. Try it out and share your feedback. As you explore early, we will follow up with more details about the terms and usage policies for experiences enabled through Siri AI. More to share soon. Greg Pierce (developer of Drafts and other fine apps): This sounds amazing, and I didn?t think we?d see App Intents integration into Siri AI until next WWDC. Siri AI is getting to the point of underpromising and overdelivering, which is where you want products to be. In 2025...

4. iPad Mini (A20 Pro) Review Roundup

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-11-03T23:45:18Z
Link: https://www.techmeme.com/261103/p15#a261103p15
David Pierce at The Verge , on the Acoustic Display: It means the sound fires out of the front panel rather than from speaker holes. (Some TVs currently work the same way.) It doesn?t sound any better than before, maybe a tiny bit bassier, but it also doesn?t sound worse, and if anything it?s slightly better to have the sound actually pointed at you instead of out the sides of the tablet. Mostly it?s a wash in service of the ruggedization, which is good enough for me. Stephen Robles, on YouTube , thinks it sounds muffled at high volumes and doesn?t seem to like how you can feel the whole tablet vibrate at high volumes. Tony Polanco at Tom?s Guide liked the Acoustic Display sound quality and praised the battery life (but only had time to run the battery test once): In the Tom?s Guide battery test, which involves continuous web-surfing over Wi-Fi with the display set to 150 nits of brightness, the iPad mini 8 lasted for an astonishing 14 hours and 24 minutes! That?s nearly four hours longer than the previous model and Apple?s claims. John Voorhees at MacStories was impressed by the Mini?s local AI performance: The mini?s local AI capabilities extend beyond software optimized for the...

5. MKBHD on the New A20 Pro iPad Mini
Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-11-03T23:25:25Z
Link: https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=g6Die8gVFn0
Marques Brownlee describes the two color choices as ?annoyingly, slightly not black and slightly not white,? which is apt. He digs the acoustic display enough that he can imagine Apple bringing it to a future high-end iPhone (like if they do a big redesign next year for the 20th anniversary), but he says you can feel the whole iPad shake if you turn the volume up high enough. And, of course, he dings it for not having a 120 Hz display, and wonders where Apple even sourced a high quality OLED that doesn?t support 120 Hz. I think that?s the wrong question to ask. It?s not about the display panel. It?s the display driver , and ProMotion requires a display driver that?s enough more expensive that adding it to the iPad Mini would either raise the price even further or cut into Apple?s profit margins. It?s the driver, though, not the panel, in my understanding. ?

6. How do you implement a random-access database when you don?t have random-access external storage?
Source: The Old New Thing | Published: Tue, 03 Nov 2026 15:00:00 +0000
Link: https://devblogs.microsoft.com/oldnewthing/20261103-00/?p=112825/
You just store it all in memory, in your own program. The post How do you implement a random-access database when you don?t have random-access external storage? appeared first on The Old New Thing .

7. Pluralistic: Separable (03 Nov 2026)
Source: Pluralistic: Daily links from Cory Doctorow | Published: Tue, 03 Nov 2026 14:19:29 +0000
Link: https://pluralistic.net/2026/11/03/nobody-is-home/
Today’s links Separable: AI makes us deal with paintings without painters, words without writers and mathematics without mathematicians. Hey look at this: Delights to delectate. Object permanence: Haircase; There’s no copyright policy; Sole and despotic dominion; Trump x fraud; Brexit requires an act of Parliament; Official Air Travel Replacement Knives; UK hospitals v malware. Upcoming appearances: Kilkenny, Courtenay, Vancouver, Folkestone, Oxford, Sheffield, Virtual, Oxford, Montreal. Recent appearances: Where I’ve been. Latest books: You keep readin’ em, I’ll keep writin’ ’em. Upcoming books: Like I said, I’ll keep writin’ ’em. Colophon: All the rest. Separable (permalink) Long before the Turing Test, there was the touring Edison Test: from 1915 to 1925, the scoundrel Thomas Edison put on a traveling show for his phonograph machine, touring venues around the USA. Edison set live performers and an Edison phonograph playing behind closed curtains that would be periodically pulled aside to reveal that the music the audience had taken to be live performance was actually a record player: https://www.tomedison.org/blog/edisons-tone-tests Now, if you’ve ever heard an Edison

phonograp...

8. Fraction comparison trick revisited
Source: John D. Cook | Published: Tue, 03 Nov 2026 14:41:25 +0000
Link: https://www.johndcook.com/blog/2026/11/03/fraction-comparison-trick-revisited/
A few years ago I wrote about a curious result: a/b is usually greater than c/d when a + d is greater than b + c. And ?usually? means with probability 11/12. As stated in the post, you can make this statement rigorous by choosing integers up to size N at random and taking the limit as N goes to infinity. We can also choose a, b, c, and d uniformly [?] The post Fraction comparison trick revisited first appeared on John D. Cook .

9. Euclidean, Spherical, and Projective Geometry
Source: John D. Cook | Published: Tue, 03 Nov 2026 12:33:10 +0000
Link: https://www.johndcook.com/blog/2026/11/03/spherical-and-projective-geometry/
Spherical geometry is very tangible because we live on a sphere. Projective geometry seems much more exotic, and yet they?re closely related. To show how they?re connected, let?s go back to the origins of non-Euclidean geometry. Euclidean geometry Here are Euclid?s five postulates, statements about what geometric objects can be constructred. To draw a straight line from [?] The post Euclidean, Spherical, and Projective Geometry first appeared on John D. Cook .

10. How a programming might reinvent the projective plane
Source: John D. Cook | Published: Tue, 03 Nov 2026 10:45:19 +0000
Link: https://www.johndcook.com/blog/2026/11/03/hack-to-rigor/
This post will show how a graphic programmer?s hack could lead to a rigorous definition of the projective plane. As mentioned in the previous post, we start by adding some ?points at infinity? to Euclidean plane to take care of exceptional situations. For example, instead of saying most pairs of lines intersect at a single [?] The post How a programming might reinvent the projective plane first appeared on John D. Cook .

11. Just a little AI resistance, as a treat
Source: Terence Eden?s Blog | Published: Tue, 03 Nov 2026 12:34:31 +0000
Link: https://shkspr.mobi/blog/2026/11/just-a-little-ai-resistance-as-a-treat/
At the recent EMFCamp, I bumped in to Professor Kate Devlin who was talking a little about the AI Resist List. I think one of the useful things we can do is loudly complain about shitty uses of AI. Here’s an example. As mentioned in a previous post, I’m contacting companies which send malformed calendar invites. One of the organisation I contacted was the British online supermarket Ocado. They?

12. New Article, Annual LFP Charity Discount
Source: Computer Things | Published: Tue, 03 Nov 2026 18:06:44 +0000
Link: https://buttondown.com/hillelwayne/archive/new-article-annual-lfp-charity-discount/
My first blog post for Antithesis is now up! It’s called Why Antithesis and is a 2000 word overview on the relative merits of Deterministic Simulation Testing as compared to Formal Methods (tldr there’s an essential tradeoff between input coverage and code fidelity). Check it out ! Also: last year I did a charity drive for the Greater Chicago Food Depository . It was successful enough that I want to run it again! From now until the end of the month, you can get Logic for Programmers at half price with the coupon feedchicago2026 . All royalties from that coupon will go to the Greater Chicago Food Depository. This is only the pdf for now because I have no idea how to make Amazon coupons yet. Thank you!

13. I wish tech companies knew more about me
Source: Rakhim’s blog | Published: Tue, 03 Nov 2026 00:00:00 GMT
Link: https://rakhim.exotext.com/i-wish-tech-companies-knew-more-about-me
"Tech companies are spying on us" is a truism at this point. Endless articles and investigations have ensured that everybody is aware: they are spying on us, they listen to our

conversations, they know more about us than we know ourselves, they know you’re going to be fired or become pregnant or become depressed before it happens... I have never felt anything close to that. I get shown ads for products I just purchased. All this spying, machine learning, big data result in "he bought a mattress, show him more mattresses". Here, I literally just opened a random website with no adblocker, and I see a purple gamepad I recently purchased, with two other gamepads: When listening to personalized playlists on Spotify and YouTube Music I skip every single electronic track with vocals. I listen to a lot of techno and related genres, and the moment someone starts singing I skip the track. I’ve been doing it for years. None of these advanced algorithms have ever noticed this simple pattern. Using Google Chrome, logged into my Google account, I searched for info about Google AI plan usage limits, got an AI-generated response with a link to the help page, clicked it and ended up, logged out, o...

14. Running Dry
Source: Ed Zitron’s Where’s Your Ed At | Published: Tue, 03 Nov 2026 17:16:20 GMT
Link: https://www.wheresyoured.at/running-dry/
If you haven?t subscribed to Where?s Your Ed At, now?s the best time. I?ve extended the sale ? 10% off of the $70-a-year subscription for life (click here!) ? for new subscribers for another week. It?s a

15. Runs scored in World Baseball Classic
Source: Entropic Thoughts | Published: Tue, 03 Nov 2026 00:00:00 +0100
Link: https://entropicthoughts.com/sums-of-overdispersed-counts
In the Spring 2026 edition of the Metaculus Cup one question concerned the number of runs in the knockout stage of the World Baseball Classic (WBC) in 2026. The community predicted a mean of just under 70 runs, with a spread of 60?80. My prediction was 60 runs, with a spread of 42?80. The actual number ended up being 59 runs ? nearly exactly what I predicted. Let?s see how that was done. First, there?s a sloppy way of making a quick guess. It?s not very interesting, but it?s a good baseline. Once we have that, we?ll dig into modeling counts on a more granular level, and that?s when it gets interesting. Those techniques can be used for all sorts of counts, not just sports prediction! I don?t know anything about baseball. I don?t even know what a run is, so I had my research assistant count how many runs were in a few of the previous WBCs. (Continue reading the full article on the web.)

16. Bottom-Up Note-Taking in Capacities
Source: Blog ? Daniel Wirtz | Published: Mon, 16 Dec 2024 00:00:00 GMT
Link: https://danielwirtz.com/blog/bottom-up-note-taking-in-capacities
Over the years, my approach to note-taking has changed dramatically. Looking at my old Evernote account, I had everything neatly organized into pages and?

17. Dynamic website CMS with Notion
Source: Blog ? Daniel Wirtz | Published: Tue, 26 Nov 2024 00:00:00 GMT
Link: https://danielwirtz.com/blog/notion-website-cms
Three years ago, I published the first version of my current website using Chakra UI, Next.js, and Airtable.

18. Audio notes to Capacities (iOS Shortcuts)
Source: Blog ? Daniel Wirtz | Published: Mon, 21 Oct 2024 00:00:00 GMT
Link: https://danielwirtz.com/blog/capacities-audio-notes
I?m currently using Capacities as my daily note-taking tool. There are a lot of things I like about capacities.